

CHAPTER 14

Economic Activities Around Us

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

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The Big Questions

1 How are economic activities classified?

✔ ANSWER

Economic activities that share similar characteristics are grouped into broad groups called **economic sectors**.

There are three main sectors:

- **Primary sector** – goods taken directly from nature (farming, fishing, mining, forestry).
- **Secondary sector** – raw materials from the primary sector made into products (factories, construction, electricity).
- **Tertiary sector** – services that support the other two (transport, banking, shops, teaching).

2 What differentiates these activities to be grouped into sectors?

✔ ANSWER

What the activity depends on and what it does:

- Primary: people depend **directly on nature** to produce goods.
- Secondary: people **transform outputs of the primary sector** into other goods.
- Tertiary: people **provide services** that support primary and secondary activities.

3 **How are the three sectors interconnected?**

✔ ANSWER

Each sector needs the others to turn natural raw materials into finished products for the consumer.

Example (AMUL): farmers milk cows (primary) → milk is made into butter, ghee, milk powder in factories (secondary) → products are transported and sold in shops (tertiary).

🤔 Think About It · A. Primary activities

? **Can you think of any primary activities that you may have seen in the past? What are the natural resources used in these activities? Name two of them and discuss your experiences with your classmates.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. **Farming** (growing wheat or vegetables) – natural resources used: soil, water, sunlight.

2. **Fishing** in a river or pond – natural resource used: water bodies and the fish in them.

(Other examples: raising cows/buffaloes for milk – animals, grass, water; collecting wood – forests.)

⭐ Let's Explore · B. Secondary activities

? **Now that we have seen some examples of secondary sector activities, can you name two more economic activities in the secondary sector?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

1. Making **sugar from sugarcane** in a sugar mill.
2. Making **bricks and pottery** from clay.

(Others: making shoes from leather, making bread/biscuits from flour, building houses.)

⭐ Dairy cooperative: from farm to plate

? **Today, the cooperative has a wide range of products made at many milk processing plants and factories all over India. Can you name a few?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Butter, ghee, cheese, milk powder, curd, paneer, ice cream, buttermilk and chocolate.

Don't Miss Out **Just like AMUL, there are many other milk cooperatives (Nandini, Mother Dairy, Aavin, Vijaya, Kevi, Sudha, Verka...). Can you name one cooperative around you that has helped groups like farmers, persons**

with disabilities, and women, to come together and has brought prosperity to their lives?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Example: **SEWA** (Self Employed Women's Association, Gujarat) helps poor working women come together, earn more and save money.

You can also name the milk cooperative of your own state (e.g. Sudha in Bihar, Verka in Punjab) or a women's self-help group in your area.

🤔 Think About It · Fig. 14.1 (from pulp to textbook)

? **Observe the different stages of the process shown in Fig. 14.1 on page 206 and discuss them with your fellow classmates.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Stages: trees are cut and wood is taken from the forest → wood is turned into pulp → pulp is made into paper in a paper mill → paper is printed and bound into books in a printing press → books are transported and sold in shops / given to schools → students read them.

All three sectors work together to make our textbook. (check the picture in your book)

⭐ Let's Explore · Fig. 14.1

? **Label the pictures in the illustration shown in Fig. 14.1 on page 206 as:**

1. Primary sector
2. Secondary sector
3. Tertiary sector

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Picture	Sector
Cutting trees / collecting wood from the forest	Primary sector
Making pulp and paper in the mill; printing and binding books	Secondary sector
Transporting paper and books by truck; selling books in shops; schools	Tertiary sector

(check the picture in your book)

⭐ Don't Miss Out · Recycling paper

? **What are the different ways through which we can judiciously use paper in the classrooms and offices of your school?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- Write on both sides of the paper.
- Use old notebooks' blank pages for rough work.

- Send notices by phone/WhatsApp or display them on the board instead of printing many copies.
- Pass on old textbooks to juniors.
- Keep a box for waste paper and send it for recycling.

⭐ Let's Explore · Activities in your neighbourhood

? List the economic activities in your neighbourhood and label them appropriately as primary, secondary or tertiary. Draw arrows to show how they are connected to each other. In what ways are they dependent on each other? What would happen if one of the activities ceased to exist?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Activity	Sector
Vegetable farming, dairy farmer	Primary
Flour mill, bakery, tailor making clothes	Secondary
Grocery shop, auto-rickshaw driver, school, bank	Tertiary

Arrows: farmer → flour mill → bakery → auto/truck → grocery shop → people.

They depend on each other: the mill needs the farmer's wheat; the bakery needs flour; the shop needs bread and transport to sell it.

If one activity stops (e.g. the flour mill closes), the farmer cannot sell wheat easily, the bakery gets no flour, and the shop has no bread to sell. Everyone's income suffers.

? Questions, activities and projects

1 **What is the primary sector? How is it different from the secondary sector? Give two examples.**

✔ ANSWER

Primary sector: activities in which people depend **directly on nature** to produce goods, i.e. taking raw materials from nature.

Difference: the secondary sector does not take goods directly from nature; it **processes the raw materials of the primary sector** into new products in mills and factories.

Primary sector	Secondary sector
Growing wheat	Making flour from wheat in a mill
Growing cotton	Making cloth from cotton in a textile factory

2 **How does the secondary sector depend on the tertiary sector? Illustrate with a few examples.**

✔ ANSWER

Factories need services to get raw materials and to sell their products.

- **Transport:** trucks bring sugarcane to the sugar mill and carry sugar to markets.
- **Trade and shops:** AMUL's butter and ghee reach people through retail shops.
- **Banking:** factories take loans and make payments through banks.
- **Electricians and mechanics** keep the machines running; **communication** (phone, internet) helps take orders.

Without these services, factory goods would stay in the factory and could not be sold.

3 **Give an example of interdependence between primary, secondary and tertiary sectors. Show it using a flow diagram.**

✔ ANSWER

Example: AMUL dairy cooperative.

Farmer milks cows (Primary) → **Milk is processed into butter, ghee, cheese, milk powder in factories** (Secondary) → **Products transported by trucks, rail, air, ships and sold in shops** (Tertiary) → **Consumer**

Another example: trees cut for wood (Primary) → pulp → paper → printed books (Secondary) → books transported and sold (Tertiary).

🎉 **Chapter 14 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**